

Make your own!



River Skater Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Pale tan, mid-brown, golden & dark-maroon felt
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The blue felt mat for pond habitat (optional)

How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 13 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the blue mat down — that's your pond!
- 4 Place the underbody, then the back on top.
- 5 Add the golden head, 2 eyes and 2 antennae.
- 6 Tuck 6 legs under — splayed out wide. Done!

Did you know?



It skates on the surface film of ponds and rivers.

Water-repellent leg hairs trap air, so it never sinks.

It feels ripples in the water to find food.

The long middle legs row; the back legs steer.

One of Britain's largest pond skaters.

The pieces



Find these colours in felt or paper



Pale tan · Mid brown · Golden · Dark maroon

Using the template, cut out:

Underbody ×1 — pale tan

Back ×1 — mid brown

Head ×1 — golden tan

Eyes ×2 — dark maroon

Legs ×6 — mid brown

Antennae ×2 — dark maroon

That's 13 shapes in total!

Finished!



Your river skater is about 11 × 9 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Slender body, legs splayed wide — the middle pair longest.

Collect the set:

Aquatic: river skater, dragonfly, bell spider



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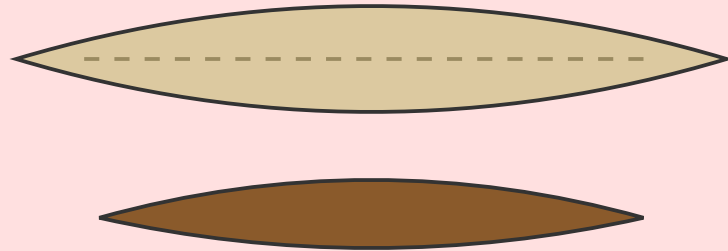
Collect the set

**Meadow · Aquatic ·
Underground**

river skater · dragonfly ·
bell spider
butterfly · ladybird ·
more...

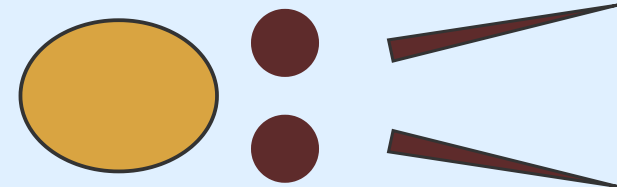
Species: *Aquarius najas*
Photo © Alfie Felton, CC0
Logo © Giant Insect World

Underbody & back



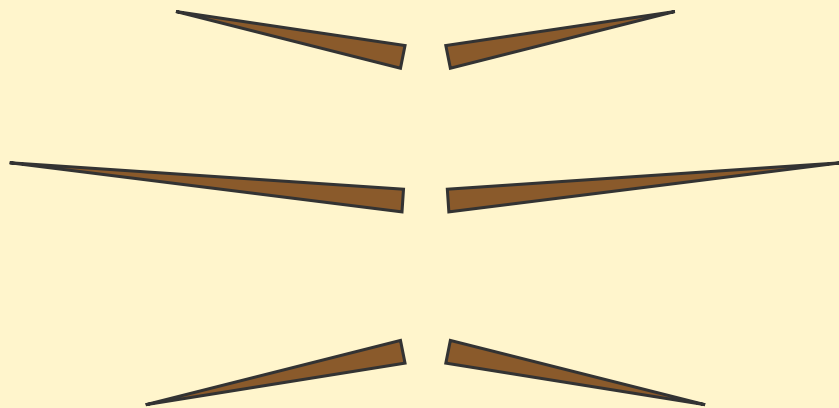
Pale-tan underbody ×1 + mid-brown back ×1
Dashed = centre guide (don't cut)

Head, eyes & antennae



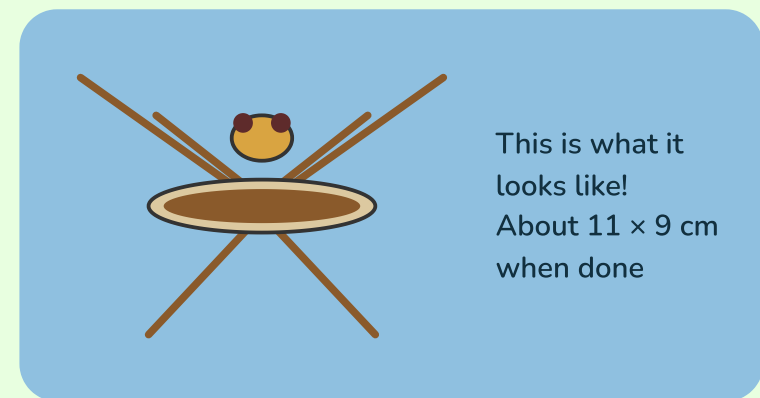
Golden head ×1 · 2 dark-maroon eyes · 2 antennae

Legs ×6



Mid-brown felt · cut 6 legs
2 short front · 2 long middle · 2 hind — separate

Finished! ★



This is what it
looks like!
About 11 × 9 cm
when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!